SCORE

compose · record · edit · perform — for Mac and iPad

SCORE is the composing sibling of ARCO. One piece, two ways to look at it: the **ARRANGER** (tracks and clips on bars — where you write) and the **SCORE LINE** (the piece as a line of stations — where you perform). Both show the same piece: a station is a moment on the arranger's ruler, and every station keeps its own sound — every knob of every effect and synth.



The arranger with the demo piece. Left: the browser. Top: transport, tempo, the three views and GO. Bottom: the devices of the selected track (or the clip editor).

The first five minutes

- The first time, SCORE opens a **demo piece** (drums, bass, chords, a cello take, three stations). Press **space** to play.
- Click **SCORE LINE** (or press 2) and press the big gold **GO**: the next station arrives and its sound glides in.
- Drop any sound file (WAV, AIFF, FLAC, MP3, M4A, OGG) anywhere on the window: it lands on a track at the playhead, copied into the piece.
- Press **+ TRACK** → NOVA, double-click its lane to write notes, play the computer keys (A W S E D F T G …, Z / X octave).
- Arm a track (**R** on it) and press the red record button. One bar of count-in, then it records.

Getting sounds in

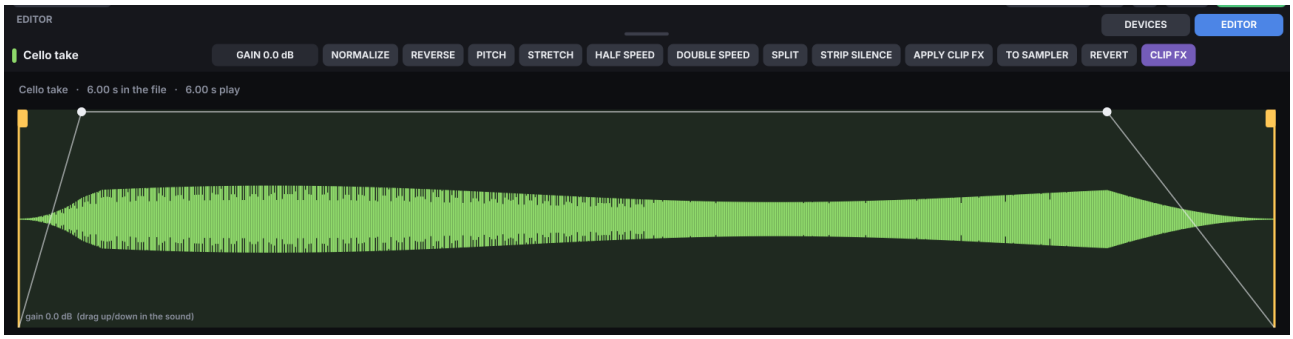
- **Drag and drop** files or folders from Finder onto a track (or anywhere). A piece folder or a .zip opens the piece.
- **IMPORT FILES** in the browser opens the system picker — on the iPad this is the Files app: iCloud Drive, Downloads, USB sticks, AirDrop.

- The **browser** lists Downloads, Music, Desktop, Documents and any folder you add (+ FOLDER). Click a file to listen, drag it to a track, double-click to put it on the selected track at the playhead. Search finds sounds in all places.
- On the iPad, SCORE's folder is visible in the Files app (On My iPad → SCORE): put sounds there and they show up in the browser.
- Every imported sound is copied into the piece's Audio folder, so a piece never loses its sounds.

Recording

- **Audio**: arm the track (R), choose its input (right-click the track → Input; Mono 1, Stereo 1+2, or the sound of another track). IN switches monitoring: OFF / AUTO / always.
- Record the **dry sound** (effects stay changeable afterwards) or **with the track's effects** (track menu → Recording).
- **Notes**: arm an instrument track and play a MIDI keyboard, the screen keyboard or the computer keys — the notes become a clip.
- **FOLLOW** (instrument track menu): the synth plays the notes that your instrument sings into the microphone.
- Recording over clips replaces that part of them. Count-in and the metronome are in the top bar (M); the click can go to its own outputs (Settings).
- Recording **in a station**: SCORE LINE → RECORD IN THIS STATION. The take belongs to that station and plays every time you come back to it.

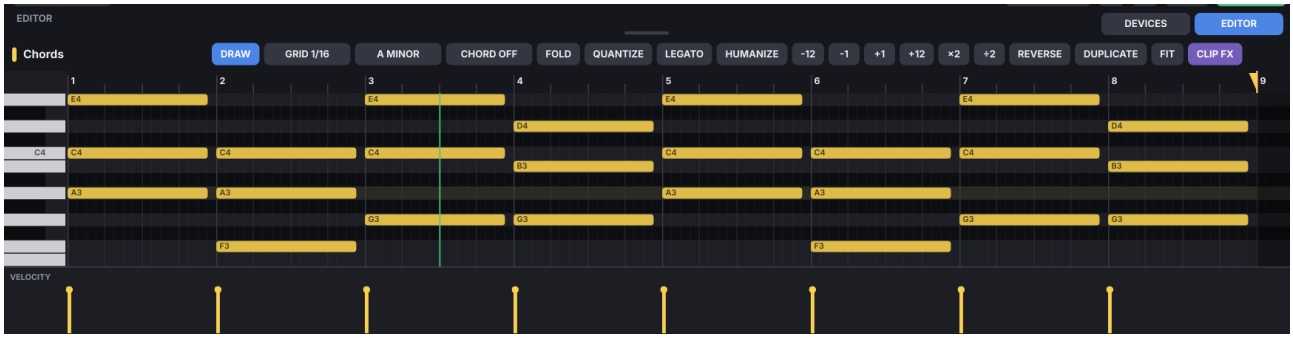
Editing a recording



Select an audio clip and open the EDITOR: drag the gold edges to trim, the white dots for fades, up / down in the sound for gain.

- **PITCH** (same length), **STRETCH** (same pitch, or fit to whole bars), **HALF / DOUBLE SPEED**, **REVERSE**, **NORMALIZE**, **STRIP SILENCE** (splits into the loud parts), **SPLIT** at the playhead.
- **CLIP FX**: effects on this clip only — e.g. a HALO on one phrase. **APPLY CLIP FX** prints them into the sound. **REVERT** brings the original back.
- **TO SAMPLER** plays the sound on the keys; right-click a clip → **Make it a NOVA wavetable** turns it into an oscillator.

Notes: the piano roll



- **DRAW**: click adds a note (drag to make it longer), drag moves, edges resize, alt-drag copies, double-click deletes. Off (or B): drag a box to select.

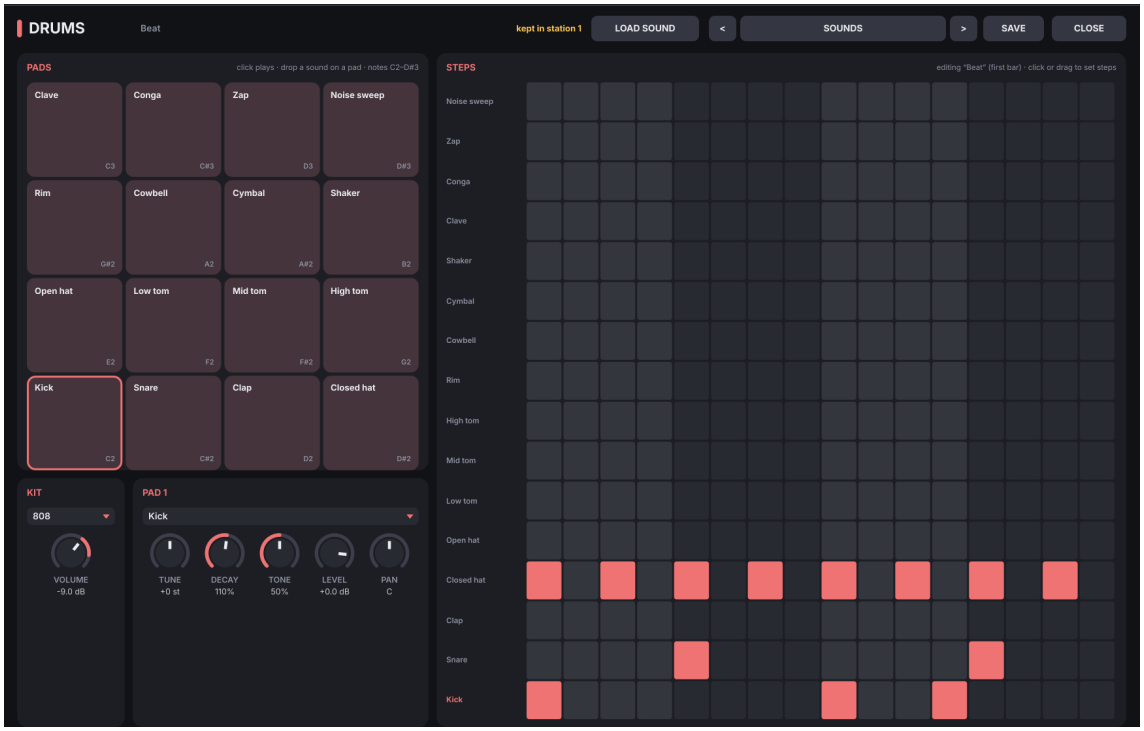
- **SCALE**: choose key and scale — notes outside are darker, and you can snap drawn notes to it. **CHORD** draws whole chords, in the key.
- **QUANTIZE**, **LEGATO**, **HUMANIZE**, transpose ±1 / ±12, ×2 / ÷2, **REVERSE**, **DUPLICATE** (cmd-D). Velocity lane at the bottom. The gold flag on the ruler is the clip's length.
- Drums show their pad names; FOLD shows only the rows that have notes.

NOVA — the synth



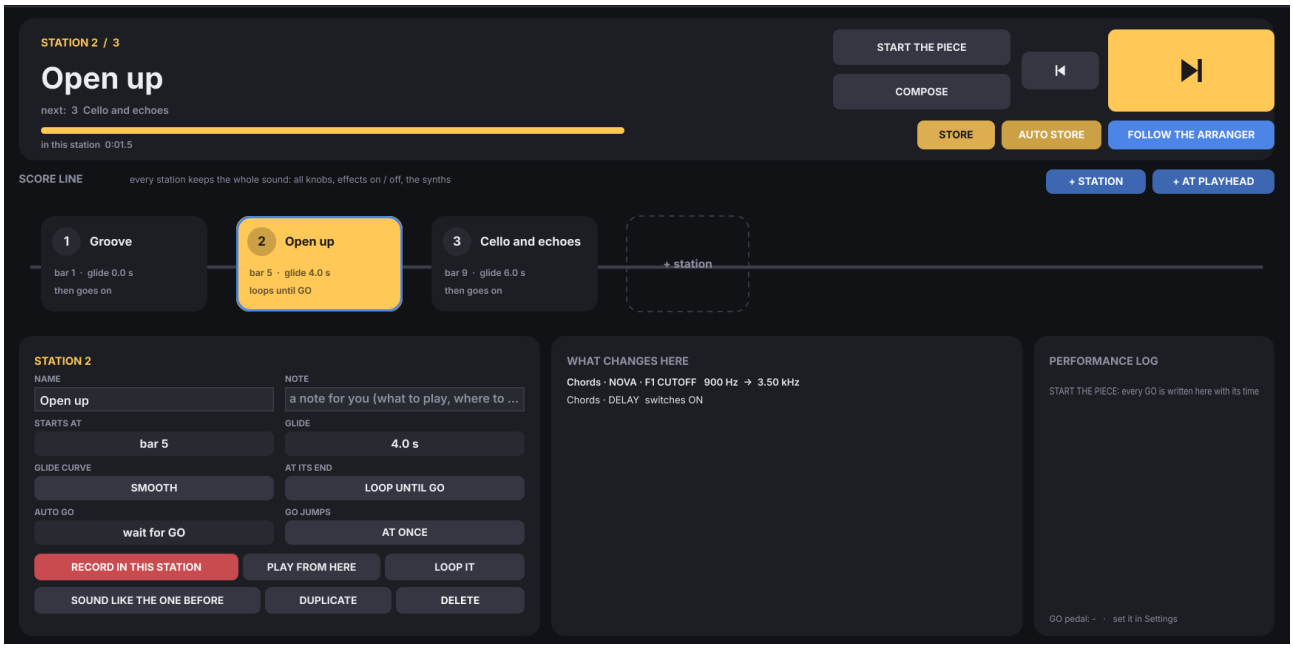
- Three wavetable oscillators (A B C): 16 frames per table, POSITION travels through them; unison up to 8 voices with detune and spread; WARP (sync, bend, FM, ring, mirror, quantize …).
- **Your sounds as wavetables**: drop a sound file on an oscillator — it becomes its table.
- SUB and NOISE, two filters (low / high / band / notch / ladder / comb / formant, serial or parallel), four envelopes, four LFOs (synced to the tempo or free), 16 modulation slots (drag the amount), four MACROS, voices / mono / legato / glide, an arpeggiator and the synth's own DRIVE, CHORUS, DELAY, REVERB.
- 40 factory sounds (SOUNDS, < >), and SAVE keeps your own under MY SOUNDS.

SAMPLER and DRUMS



- **SAMPLER**: any sound across the keys, or sliced (equal parts or at the transients), one-shot, loop with crossfade, filter, envelope.
- **DRUMS**: 16 pads — four synthesized kits (808, 909, acoustic, lo-fi) or your samples (drop a sound on a pad). **STEPS** is a 16-step sequencer that writes into the selected clip (or makes one).

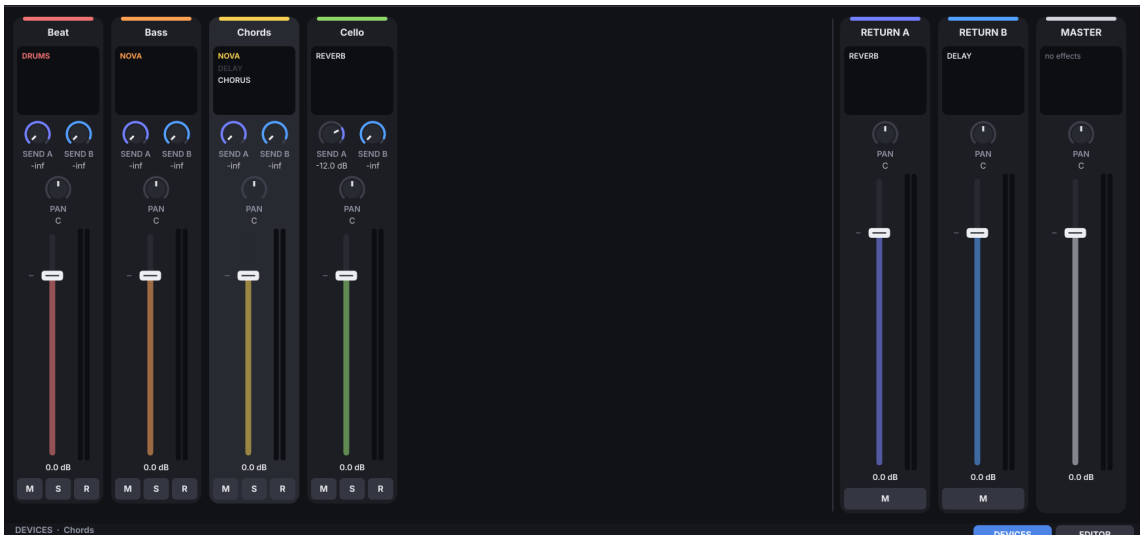
The SCORE LINE — stations



- A **station** is a moment of the piece. Make one with + STATION, + AT PLAYHEAD, or double-click the arranger's ruler.
- **Each station keeps the whole sound**: every knob of every effect, synth and mixer channel, and which effects are on. With **AUTO STORE** on, whatever you turn belongs to the station you are in; moving to another station brings its own knobs back. (With it off, STORE keeps the sound.)
- **GLIDE**: how long the knobs take to travel to this station's values (linear, smooth, slow or fast start).
- **AT ITS END**: go on, loop until GO, or stop and wait for GO. **AUTO GO** moves on by itself after some seconds. **GO JUMPS** at once, on the next beat or on the next bar.

- **WHAT CHANGES HERE** lists every knob that is different from the station before. SOUND LIKE THE ONE BEFORE copies it.
- **PERFORM**: GO / BACK (space bar, arrows, or a MIDI pedal — learn it in Settings) and START THE PIECE writes a performance log with times. **COMPOSE**: a click jumps to a station's sound at once, nothing plays.
- **FOLLOW THE ARRANGER**: when the arranger plays into a station, its sound arrives with its glide.

Mixing



- Every track: volume, pan, two sends, mute / solo / arm. **RETURN A** is a reverb, **RETURN B** a delay — change or add effects on them like on any track. The **MASTER** has its own effects (e.g. LIMITER).
- **26 effects**: EQ, filter, auto-wah, compressor, gate, limiter, pump (sidechain feel), drive, tape, crush, ring, chorus, flanger, phaser, tremolo, delay, reverb (with shimmer / freeze), reverse, resonator, halo (harmonizer), pitch, freeze, grain, stutter, width, utility.
- **Automation**: right-click any knob → Automate this knob. The lane opens under the track: click adds points, drag moves them, double-click removes.
- **Bounce** (track menu): the track with its effects becomes an audio track.

Saving, sending, exporting

- Pieces live in Music/SCORE on the Mac and in SCORE's folder on the iPad (the Files app). cmd-S saves (the first time it asks for a name); SCORE also saves every two minutes and when you quit.
- **EXPORT**: the mix or one file per track (stems), the whole piece, the loop or one station, 16 / 24 / 32-bit WAV, normalized or not, with a tail. Files go to the piece's Exports folder; SAVE / SHARE sends a copy anywhere.
- **Send the whole piece** (file menu): one .zip with every sound — open it on another Mac or iPad.

Keys

space	play / stop (in PERFORM on the score line: GO)
R · L · M · G	record · loop · metronome · GO
1 2 3, Tab	arranger · score line · mixer
A W S E D F T G Y H U J K	play notes · Z X change the octave
cmd Z / shift cmd Z	undo / redo (everything can be undone)
cmd S · cmd N · cmd I	save · new piece · import sounds
cmd D · delete · cmd E	duplicate · delete · split at the playhead

right-click / long-press	menus everywhere (long-press on the iPad)

Installing

- **Mac**: download SCORE-mac.zip from the release, unzip, move SCORE to Applications. The first time: right-click → Open (it is not from the App Store). It runs on Apple Silicon and Intel, macOS 11 or newer.
- **iPad**: SCORE.ipa with Sideloadly (like ARCO): plug in the iPad, drag SCORE.ipa into Sideloadly, type your Apple ID, Start. Then on the iPad: Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → Trust; Developer Mode on. It runs for 7 days, Sideloadly renews it.
- Microphone: the iPad’s own microphone, or any audio interface / USB microphone you plug in (choose it in Settings).